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Outer garment, cloak, mantle, robe

6.2 Outer garment, cloak, mantle, robe

References:

Hebrew כְּסוּת (ksuth) DEU 22:12

Hebrew מַחֲלָצוֹת (machalatsah) ISA 3:22, ZEC 3:4

Hebrew מִטְפַּחַת (mitpachath) RUT 3:15, ISA 3:22

Hebrew מְעִיל (mʿil) 1SA 2:19, 1SA 15:27, 1SA 18:4, 1SA 24:5, 1SA 24:12, 1SA 24:12, 1SA 28:14, 2SA 13:18, 1CH 15:27, EZR 9:3, EZR 9:5, JOB 1:20, JOB 2:12, JOB 29:14, PSA 109:29, ISA 59:17, ISA 61:10, EZK 26:16

Hebrew מַעֲטָפָה (maʿatefeth) ISA 3:22

Hebrew שַׂלְמָה (salmah) EXO 22:8, EXO 22:25, DEU 24:13, DEU 29:4, JOS 9:5, JOS 9:13, JOS 22:8, 1KI 10:25, 1KI 11:29, 1KI 11:30, 2CH 9:24, NEH 9:21, JOB 9:31, PSA 104:2, SNG 4:11, MIC 2:8

Hebrew שִׂמְלָה (simlah) GEN 9:23, GEN 35:2, GEN 37:34, GEN 41:14, GEN 44:13, GEN 45:22, GEN 45:22, EXO 3:22, EXO 12:34, EXO 12:35, EXO 19:10, EXO 19:14, EXO 22:26, DEU 8:4, DEU 10:18, DEU 21:13, DEU 22:3, DEU 22:5, JOS 7:6, JDG 8:25, RUT 3:3, RUT 3:3, 2SA 12:20, 2SA 12:20, PRO 30:4, ISA 3:6, ISA 3:7, ISA 4:1, ISA 9:4

Aramaic סַרְבָּל (sarbal) DAN 3:21, DAN 3:27

Greek διπλοῖς (diplois) BAR 5:2

Greek ἐπενδύτης (ependutēs) JHN 21:7

Greek ἱμάτιον (himation) MAT 5:40, MAT 9:16, MAT 9:16, MAT 9:20, MAT 9:21, MAT 14:36, MAT 17:2, MAT 21:7, MAT 21:8, MAT 24:18, MAT 27:31, MAT 27:35, MRK 2:21, MRK 5:27, MRK 5:28, MRK 5:30, MRK 6:56, MRK 9:3, MRK 10:50, MRK 11:7, MRK 11:8, MRK 13:16, MRK 15:20, MRK 15:24, LUK 5:36, LUK 5:36, LUK 6:29, LUK 7:25, LUK 8:27, LUK 8:44, LUK 19:35, LUK 19:36, LUK 22:36, LUK 23:34, JHN 13:4, JHN 13:12, JHN 19:2, JHN 19:5, JHN 19:23, JHN 19:24, ACT 7:58, ACT 9:39, ACT 12:8, ACT 14:14, ACT 16:22, ACT 18:6, ACT 22:20, ACT 22:23, HEB 1:11, HEB 1:12, JAS 5:2, 1PE 3:3, REV 3:4, REV 3:5, REV 3:18, REV 4:4, REV 16:15, REV 19:13, REV 19:16

Greek ἱματισμός (himatismos) LUK 7:25, LUK 9:29, JHN 19:24, ACT 20:33, 1TI 2:9, JDT 12:15, LJE 1:11, LJE 1:19, LJE 1:32, LJE 1:57, 1MA 11:24

Greek περιβόλαιον (peribolaion) 1CO 11:15, HEB 1:12

Greek ποδήρης (podērēs) REV 1:13, SIR 27:8

Greek στολή (stolē) MRK 12:38, MRK 16:5, LUK 15:22, LUK 20:46, REV 6:11, REV 7:9, REV 7:13, REV 7:14, REV 22:14, JDT 10:7, JDT 16:7, JDT 16:8, ESG 5:1, ESG 6:8, ESG 6:11, ESG 8:15, SIR 6:29, SIR 6:31, SIR 45:10, SIR 50:11, BAR 4:20, BAR 5:1, 1MA 6:15, 1MA 10:21, 1MA 14:9, 2MA 3:15, 2MA 5:2, 1ES 4:17, 1ES 4:54, 1ES 5:44, PSS 11:7

Greek φαιλόνης (failonēs) 2TI 4:13

Greek χλαμύς (chlamus) MAT 27:28, MAT 27:31, 2MA 12:35

Description and usage:

(Image generated by ChatGPT using OpenAI technology)The cloak was a long, flowing outer garment reaching to the feet. It was generally a loose-fitting cloth that was draped around the body and held in place in the middle by a sash wrapped around the waist (see 6.6 Waistband, sash, belt<REALIA:6.6>) or some means of fastening such as pins or buttons. The cloak was worn at all levels of society, including also priests and other religious leaders. It served more purposes than just an outer covering. Women sometimes carried bowls or other implements or grain (see EXO 22:26) in its folds. For poorer people it also served as a covering when sleeping. For this reason Jewish law prohibited taking a person's robe overnight as a guarantee (EXO 22:26 [25]).

For the robe of the High Priest, see 4.5.3 Robe<REALIA:4.5.3>.

Translation:

The outer garment is referred to by a number of Hebrew and Greek terms that are not easily distinguished. The choice of an equivalent for these terms relating to "outer garment" will depend largely upon the specific context and the usage in each receptor language. The most common equivalent is usually a term meaning "coat." In some passages the long robe is culturally significant as an indication of high social status and dignified occupation or activity.

Some Bible passages refer to people tearing their clothes. This was done as an act of grief (see GEN 37:34; JOS 7:6; 2SA 1:11; 2SA 3:31; 2SA 13:31; 2KI 5:7; EZR 9:3; EZR 9:5; EST 4:1; JOB 1:20; JOB 2:12). Translators may expand the expression for tearing clothes; for example, in JOB 1:20 a GNT has "Then Job got up and tore his clothes in grief," where the addition of "in grief" makes clear the purpose of the gesture. It is also possible to translate the meaning of the gesture only; for example, "Job stood up full of grief" or "Job got to his feet, his heart broken." Where there is a common local custom used to display grief, it may be helpful to keep the biblical custom in the text and to compare it to the local custom in a note; for example, the note may read "This is equivalent to the practice of painting the face to show that the person is in mourning."

RUT 3:15: The Hebrew word *mitpachath* would normally be expected to mean a kind of "veil" (KJV; compare ISA 3:22). In this context, however, it is clear that a veil of thin material would not have been strong enough to carry the weight of the barley. Older translations understood it to be a kind of "mantle" (RSV), while modern translations prefer something like "cloak" (GNT, REB). Others look for a more modern equivalent, such as "cape" (CEV) or "shawl" (NJPSV, NCV).

ISA 3:22: Sheffer suggests translating the Hebrew word *machalatsoth* (plural of *machalatsah*) in this verse as "loincloths." It is probably better to say "cloaks" or "shawls."

1TI 2:9: The Greek word *himatismos* in this verse is the general word for garments of any kind, but since women are being referred to, then the word "dresses" (GNT) will fit this context if "dresses" are the natural wear in a translator's culture. However, in cultures where women wear some other type of clothing, translators should use a more general word, as the Greek does.